

JSS 1 ISLAMIC RELIGIOUS STUDIES – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 7: RULES OF MIM SAKINAH

1. Meaning of Mim Sakinah

Mim Sakinah (ميم) is the letter Meem that carries a sukun (no vowel). It is pronounced by closing the lips. The rules of Mim Sakinah are called **Shafawi** (labial) rules because Meem is articulated with the lips.

2. The Three Rules of Mim Sakinah

There are only three rules for Mim Sakinah, depending on the letter that follows it:

Rule 1: IDGHAM SHAFAWI (Labial Merging) – ميم ياء

When: Mim Sakinah is followed by another **Meem (ميم)**.

How to read: The two Meems are merged into one Meem with shaddah (stress), and a ghunnah (nasal sound) of two counts is applied.

Examples:

- كُنتُمْ مُمِينِينَ (kuntum-mu'mineen)
- لَاهُم مَاءٌ (lahum-maa)
- فَعُولُوبِهِمْ مَرَادُونَ (fee quloobihim-maradun)

Rule 2: IKHFA SHAFAWI (Labial Concealment) – ميم باء

When: Mim Sakinah is followed by the letter **Baa (باء)**.

How to read: The Meem is partially hidden (lips are lightly closed), and a ghunnah of two counts is applied. The sound is soft and nasal.

Examples:

- تَرْمِيهِمْ بِيحِبَّارَاتِينَ (tarmeehim-bi-hijaaratin)
- وَاهُمْ بِلْأَخِيرَاتِي (wa hum-bil-aakhirati)
- يَا تَاسِيمُ بِلْأَهِي (ya'tasim-billaahi)

Rule 3: IZHAR SHAFAWI (Labial Clarity) – ميم غير ميم وباء

When: Mim Sakinah is followed by any letter other than Meem and Baa (the remaining 26 letters).

How to read: The Meem is pronounced clearly and fully by closing the lips, without any ghunnah or merging.

Examples:

- أَنْأَمْتُ أَلَيْهِمْ (an'amta 'alayhim)
- لَكُمْ دَعْنُكُمْ (lakum deenukum)
- هُمْ فَعْهَاءٌ (hum feehaa)

3. Summary Table

Rule	Following Letter	How to Read
------	------------------	-------------

Idgham Shafawi	■ (Meem)	Merge into one Meem + ghunnah
Ikhfa Shafawi	■ (Baa)	Hide partially + ghunnah
Izhar Shafawi	Any other letter	Pronounce clearly, no ghunnah

4. Practical Tips

- Always close the lips properly when pronouncing Meem.
- For Idgham and Ikhfa, hold the ghunnah for approximately two counts (like saying 'nn').
- Practise with short Surahs to identify these rules easily.
- Listen to a qualified Qari and imitate the correct sound.

End of Topic 7 – Rules of Mim Sakinah